

TEACHING TIPS:

- The best way to learn this song is to **listen to it** a good few times. Put it on in the background as you work on some creative Easter crafts and you'll find when you come to sing it, so much is already embedded.
- It can be easy to go out of tune (flat) when singing a downward phrase such as 'He is risen! Love is here' and 'Hallelujah'. To encourage the children to 'think' upwards as they sing down, ask them to raise their arms in front of them, as if lifting the air.
- Make sure that the long notes on 'Je-sus' in bars 32-33, and again in the final two bars, are held for their full lengths, and that everybody comes off together so that there are no hissing snakes on the final 's'!

Notation

Improvise

Sing

Listen

Play

Compose

Genre/History/Musicians

WHAT YOU NEED

Your body!

DID YOU KNOW?

Lots of **nursery rhymes** are written with a $\frac{6}{8}$ time signature: *Hickory Dickory Dock*, *Hey Diddle Diddle*, *Humpty Dumpty*, *Pop Goes The Weasel*, *Ring A Ring O' Roses*. Do the class know any of these? Could they incorporate any rhythms from these songs into their body percussion pieces?

ACTIVITY

AGES
7-11



This song is in a $\frac{6}{8}$ **time signature**. Listen to the backing track (the second verse onwards, when the drums come in, will be easiest) and ask the children to clap or step along to the beat (**pulse**) of the music. Some children may clap a slow pulse (two dotted crotchet beats per bar) and others may clap quickly (with six quaver beats per bar). $\frac{6}{8}$ is known as a **compound time signature** because, most commonly, each bar is divided into two beats of three quavers.

Now, split the class into two groups and have one clap the quaver pulse with a slight accent on the first quaver (1 2 3 4 5 6) and the other clap the dotted crotchets (1-and-a 2-and-a). Now swap over. Can they 'stamp' or move from one foot to the other in a dotted-crotchet pulse, whilst clapping the quavers? Now, try tapping the quaver beats on the left leg, and the dotted crotchet pulse on the right leg. (Or tap with both hands on a desk top if you prefer.) Now swap over hands.

This is tricky, but good for the brain!

RHYTHM



Pulse – the beat, or steady heartbeat of the music

Time signature – an indication of rhythm/metre which gives the number of beats per bar

Compound time signature – where strong beats are subdivided by three rather than two

Crotchet $\frac{1}{4}$ – a musical note with a time value equal to two quavers

Quaver $\frac{1}{8}$ – a musical note with a time value equal to half a crotchet

Dotted crotchet $\frac{3}{8}$ – a musical note with a time value equal to one and a half crotchets

STEP IT UP



Introduce one other common $\frac{6}{8}$ rhythm (crotchet, quaver, crotchet, quaver). In small groups, using their three rhythms, can the class make up a piece of **body percussion**? Use stamping, clapping, tapping, patting the knees, clicking fingers – anything goes, as long as it is rhythmic and in time!



WHAT'S ACHIEVABLE?

To begin to understand the construction of a $\frac{6}{8}$ time signature.

To internalize a $\frac{6}{8}$ pulse.

To improvise a piece of body percussion in $\frac{6}{8}$.